



QUALITY IN AIR TRANSPORT

International Air Transport Association

Please reply to Geneva

Quoting Reference 6650

June 8, 1971

Mr. [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

West Germany

Dear Mr. [REDACTED]

Mr. Hammarskjöld has asked me to reply to your letter of May 5 on the subject of UFOs. It is correct that he made reference to this subject when addressing the Aviation/Space Writers Association Annual News Conference in New York on May 23, 1966. The following is the exact text of his remarks on UFOs:

"I believe in these things. Of course it is necessary to sift and sort all the information and to be as realistic as possible. I still feel that I must pose two rhetorical questions. Firstly, is it really that unlikely that there exist civilizations outside our planet which are more developed, both technically and mentally, than we are? Secondly, are these space neighbours of ours getting more interested in what we are doing as our own technical abilities develop? It is of course a moot point whether this possible interest from outer space, which apparently has increased during the last decade, is only a reflection of our increased opportunity to observe what is happening around us.

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"I introduce this contentious subject not because it is something topical but because of the political repercussions that this may have on our future outlook in the air transport field. The possible existence of neighbours in space will, if confirmed, create problems of legal, political and technical characteristics. While this may not be something that has to be solved today, it is certainly something to which we must give serious consideration in the future."

Regarding your query as to whether Mr. Hammarskjöld ever spoke to his uncle, the late Dag Hammarskjöld on the subject of UFOs, the answer is he did not.

In conclusion, I should point out that since joining IATA Mr. Hammarskjöld has been so busy in directing the Association's activities that he has had no time to deal further with the subject of UFOs or to make further comments on the subject.

Yours truly,



Anthony Vandyk
Public Relations Director

P.S. I am returning herewith the reply coupon which you sent with your letter.

Enc.

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